Bobathon - IBM i Application Modernization with Bob

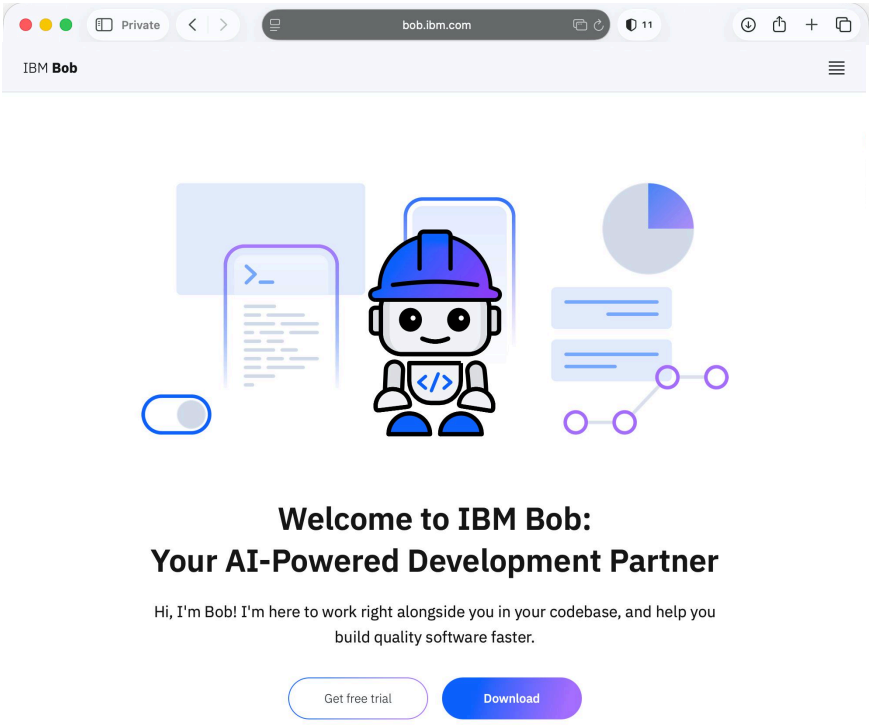
Setup for Lab
101 + 103 + 105

Please follow the below steps to ensure a smooth experience during the session. Should you run into any problems, please contact your instructor: varun.sreekumar@ibm.com

I: INSTALLING SOFTWARE

1 Download Bob IDE

Download and install BOB IDE at this link. (`https://bob.ibm.com`)

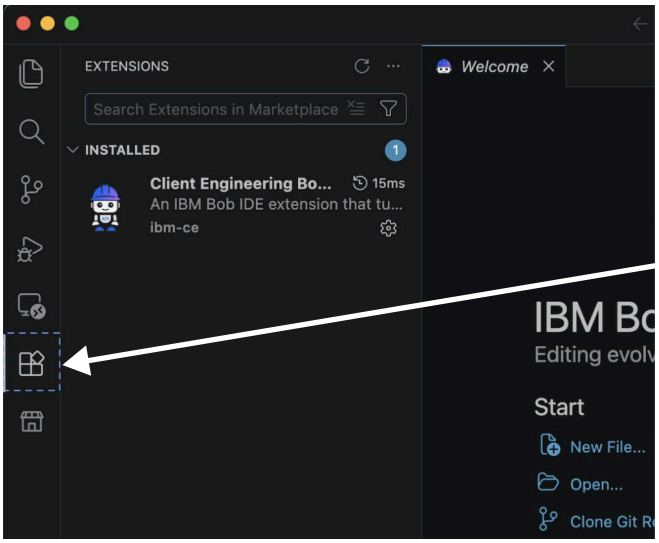


An IBM ID has been created for you with your Honda email address. You can use it to sign into Bob.
If you are experiencing issues, please create an IBM ID using your Honda email address at this link. (`https://www.ibm.com/account/reg/us-en/signup`)

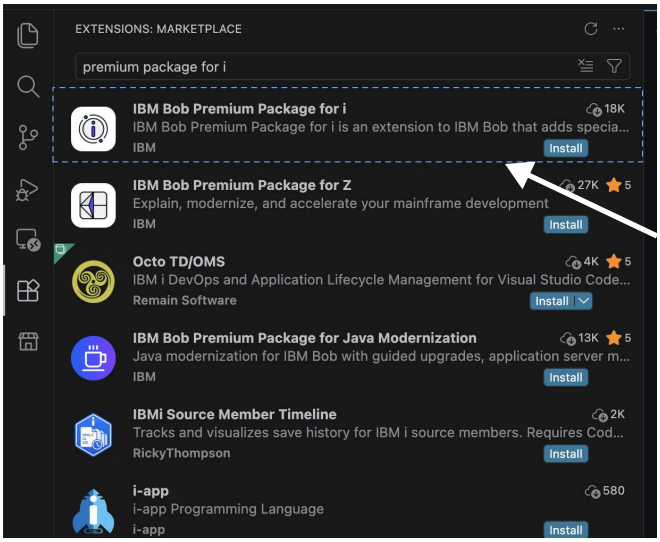
If having problems, please contact your instructor before the session.

2 Obtain Premium Package for i (PPi)

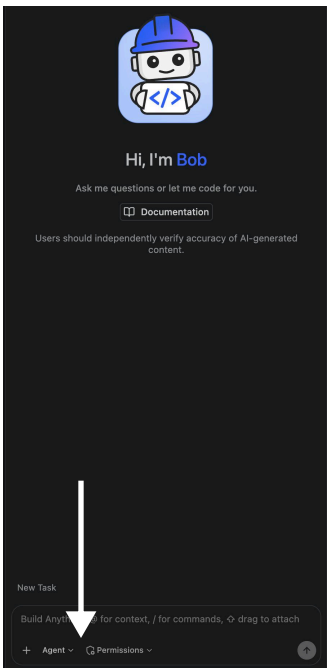
Inside Bob IDE, open the Extensions panel and install Premium Package for i (.vsix) from the marketplace.

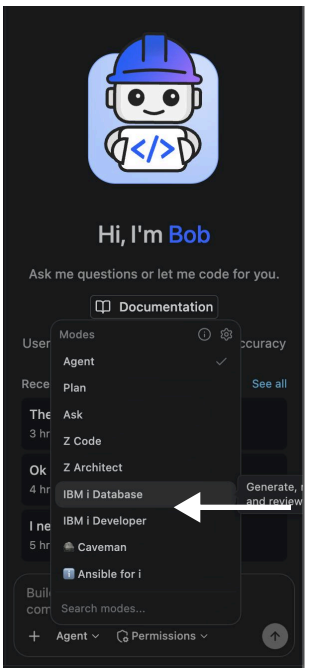


i. find the extensions icon on the left hand panel



ii. search for premium package for i and install the highlighted result

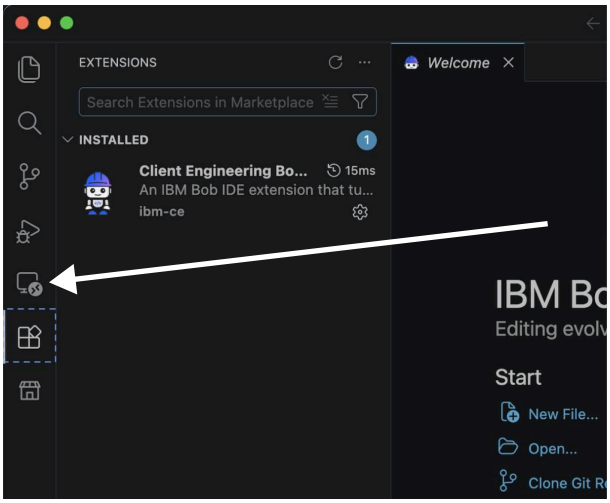




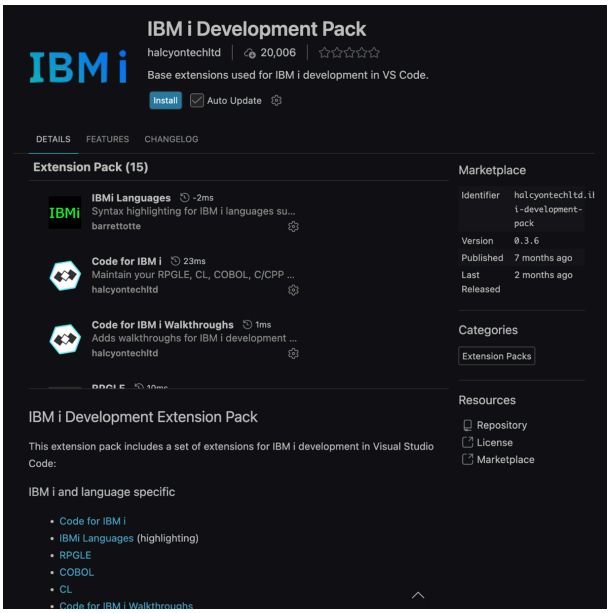
iii. verify it worked by opening the Bob chat panel and checking the mode selector for IBM i developer

3 Install IBM i Development Pack

Install the IBM i Development Pack from the Extensions Marketplace inside BOB IDE.



i. find the extensions marketplace icon on the left hand panel



ii. search for and install the IBM i Development Pack. This includes Code for IBM i, which connects Bob to the IBM i system.



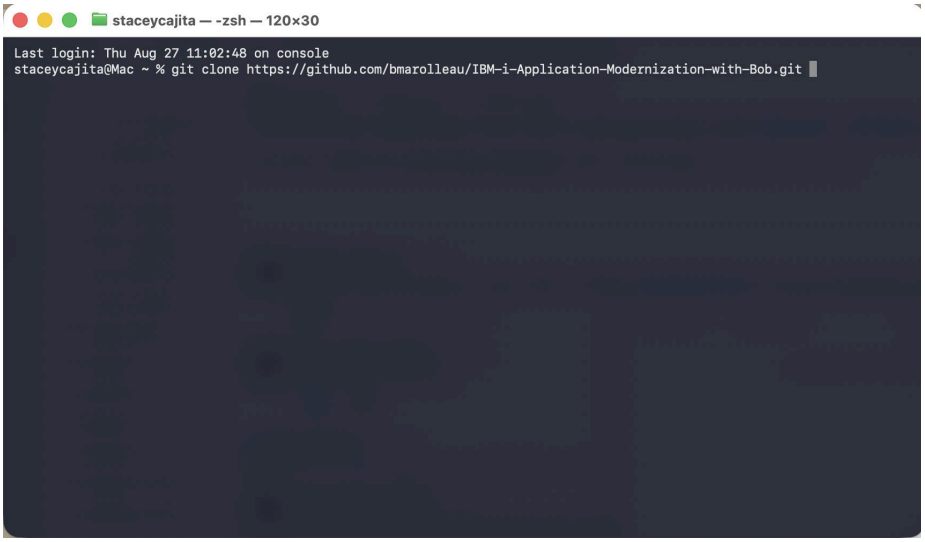
After installing, look for the IBM i icon in the left sidebar. This opens the IBM i panel used to manage connections and library lists.

> If the IBM i icon doesn't appear, make sure the workspace folder is trusted. Look for a trust prompt in the top bar of Bob IDE and click Trust.

4 Clone the Repository

Open the terminal on your machine and run:

```
git clone https://github.com/bmarolleau/IBM-i-Application-Modernization-with-Bob.git
```



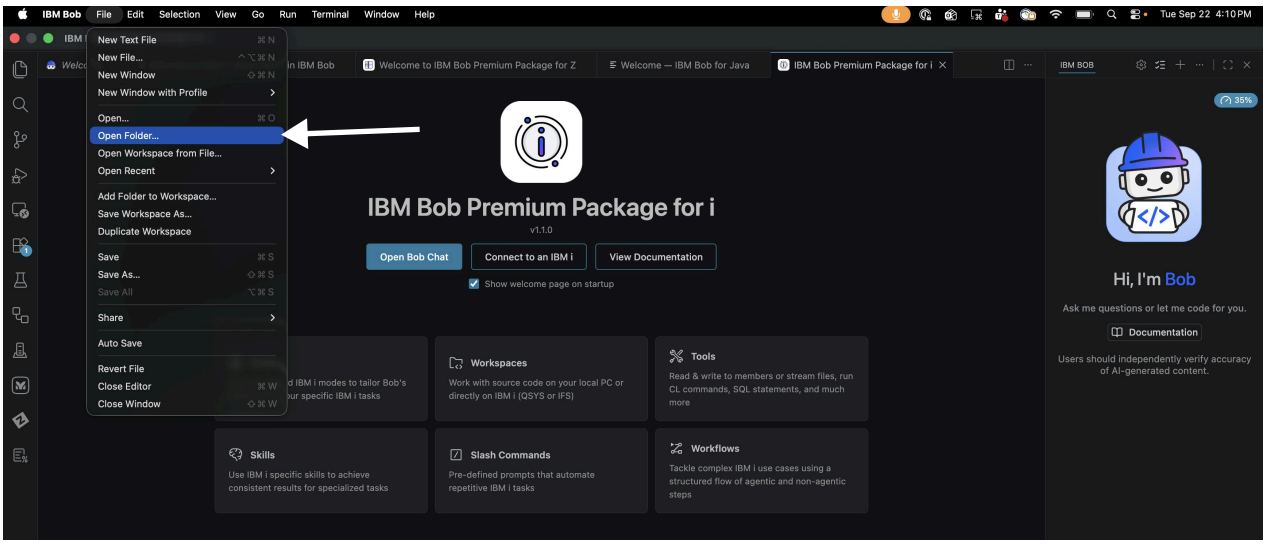
> For Windows, to open terminal, press WINDOWS KEY + X, then select Terminal (Admin). You can also click the search bar in the bottom left corner of your screen / press WINDOWS KEY, then type either 'terminal' or 'cmd' and press ENTER.

> For Mac, to open terminal, press F4 or the search button on your keyboard and search 'terminal' and the Terminal function should show up. Press RETURN on your keyboard to open the terminal.

This creates a local copy of the SAMCO application source code on your workstation.

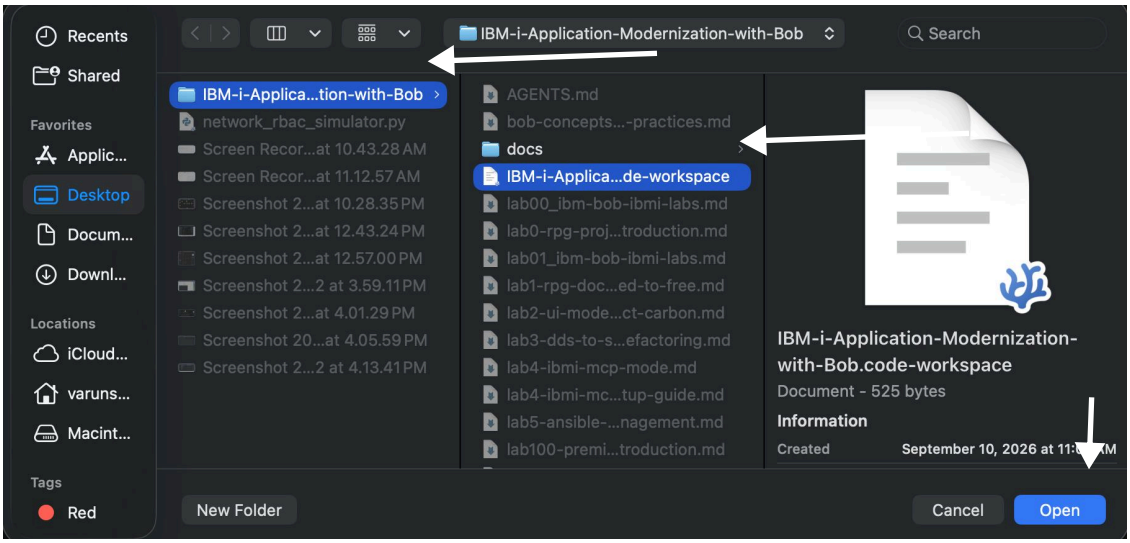
5 Open the Workspace in BOB IDE

In Bob IDE: File → Open Folder → select the cloned repo folder (IBM-i-Application-Modernization-with-Bob).

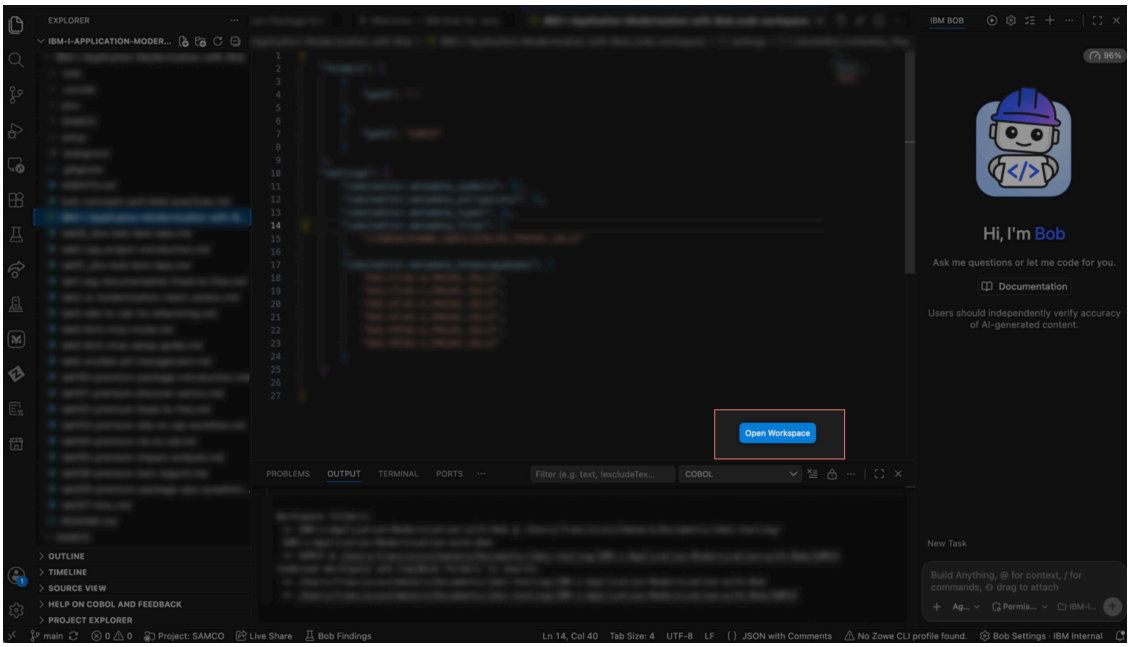


5 Open the Workspace in BOB IDE

In Bob IDE: File → Open Folder → select the cloned repo folder (IBM-i-Application-Modernization-with-Bob). Select the workspace file and open it.



Once the folder is open, you will see a notification at the bottom of the screen asking if you want to open a workspace file. Click Open Workspace.



If the notification disappears before you click it, use File -> Open Workspace from File... and select:

```
IBM-i-Application-Modernization-with-Bob.code-workspace
```

> If you are asked whether to trust the workspace, click Trust. The IBM i icon in the sidebar will not appear until the folder is trusted.

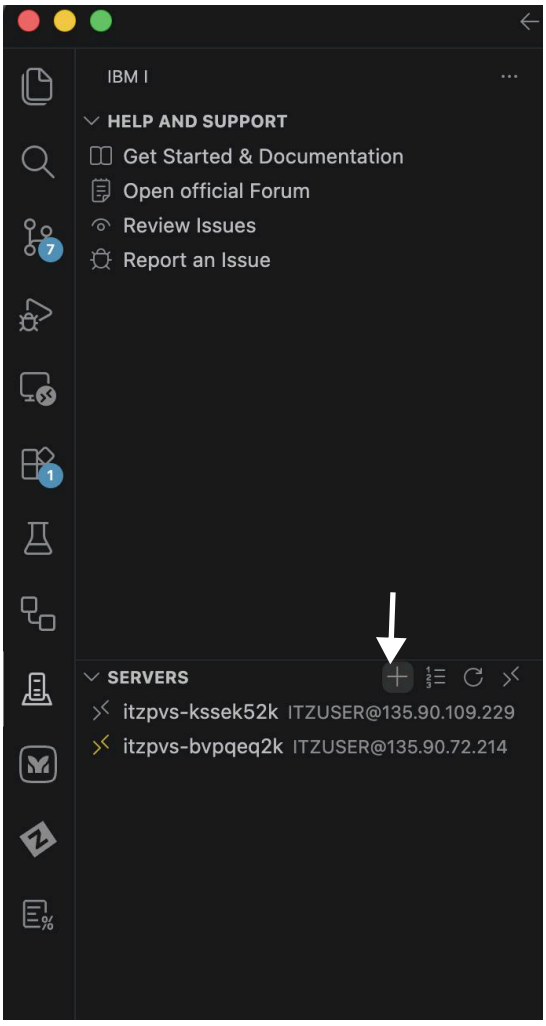
6 Connect to IBM i

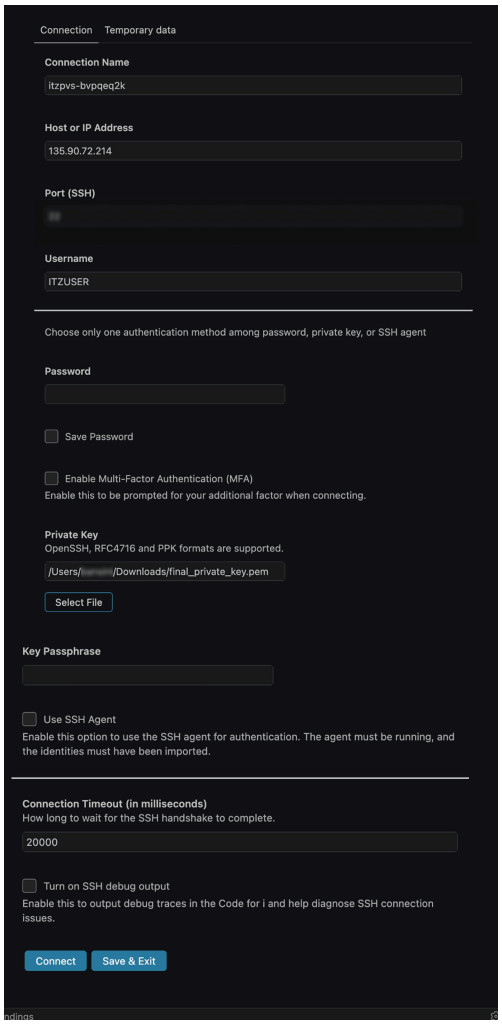


Click the IBM i icon in the left sidebar to open the IBM i panel. If the icon is not visible, make sure the workspace folder is trusted by looking for a trust prompt in the top bar and clicking 'Yes, I trust the authors.'

In the IBM i panel, click New Connection and enter:

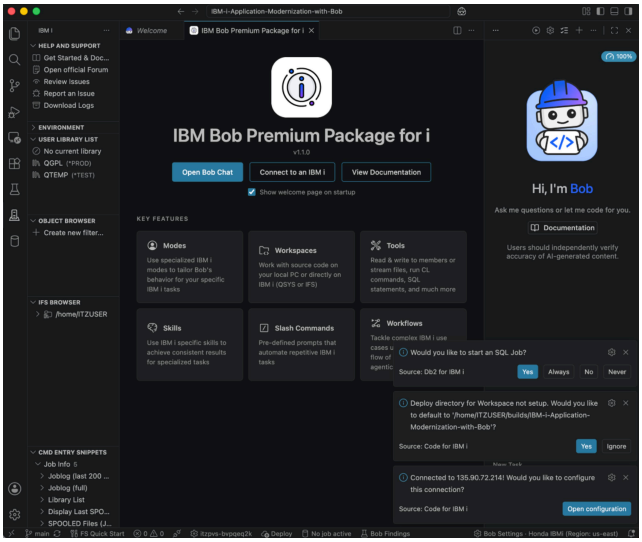
Field	*Value*
Connection Name	itzpvs-bvpqeq2k
Host or IP Address	135.90.72.214
Username	ITZUSER
Authentication	Private Key
Private Key File	Click Select File and choose the .pem file provided by your instructor





6 Connect to IBM i

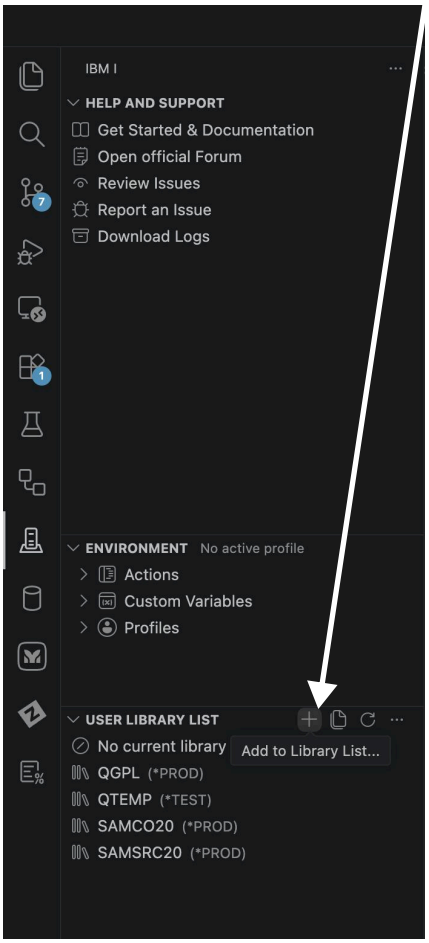
After connecting, the IBM Bob Premium Package for i welcome screen will open. You may also see notification prompts at the bottom right. Close them with the X, **do not** click Yes.



what you should see after connecting

7 Set Your Library List

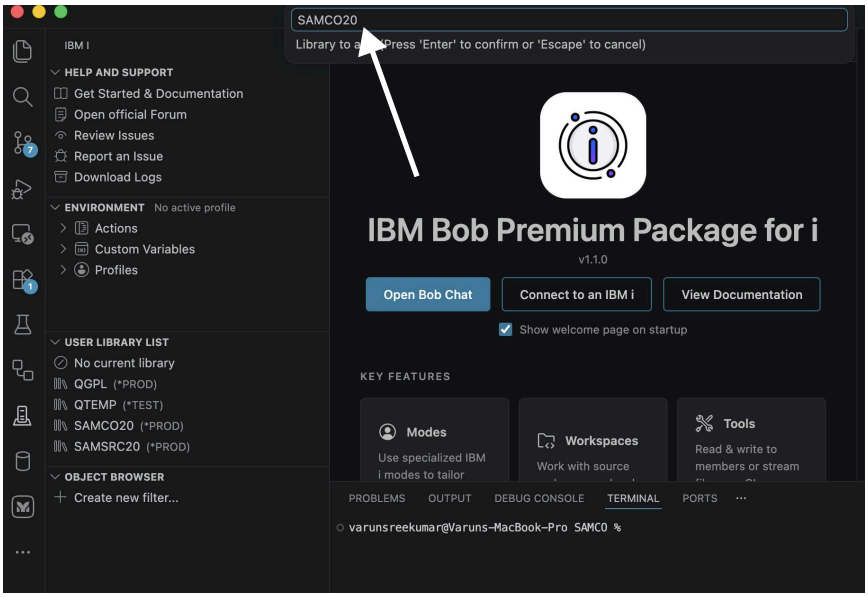
In the IBM Bob Premium Package for i panel (prem package icon png), find the User Library List section.



7 Set Your Library List

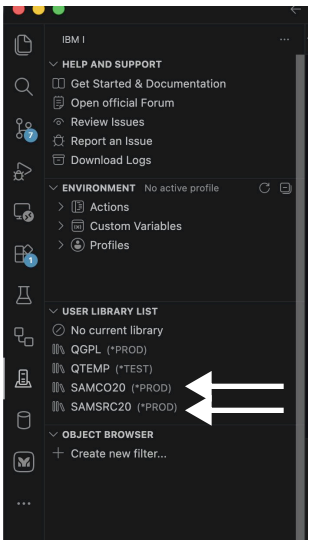
Add your two team libraries: **SAMCO{n}** and **SAMSRC{n}**
Replace {n} with your team number (e.g. team 3 → SAMCO3 and SAMSRC3). Your team number is unique:

Name	SAMCO(n)	SAMSRC(n)
Britto Moses	SAMCO1	SAMSRC1
Divya Kunnath	SAMCO2	SAMSRC2
Amit Jain	SAMCO3	SAMSRC3
Sankar Goli	SAMCO4	SAMSRC4
Jay Sharma	SAMCO5	SAMSRC5
Yozo Handa	SAMCO6	SAMSRC6
Joseph Lewis	SAMCO7	SAMSRC7
Mark Grimes	SAMCO8	SAMSRC8
David Bardes	SAMCO9	SAMSRC9
Mallikarjuna Rao	SAMCO10	SAMSRC10
Saravana Banda	SAMCO11	SAMSRC11
Korey Bentley	SAMCO12	SAMSRC12



> If the User Library List shows a "Force Enable" button or says it is disabled, click Force Enable first, then add your libraries.

When both libraries are added, it should look like this (with your own team number instead of 16):



8 Set The Build Variable in .env

In the Explorer panel (the file tree on the left), open the file `SAMCO/.env`. You will see an existing line:

```
LIBL=QGPL QTEMP
```

Add a new line 2 below it with your team library. The code should look like this:

```
LIBL=QGPL QTEMP
lib1=SAMCO{n}
```

Replace {n} with your team number. Save the file (Cmd+S / Ctrl+S) after adding the line.

> Do not remove or edit the LIBL line — just add the lib1 line below it. This tells the build system which library to compile objects into.

> If the .env file does not appear, right click on the SAMCO directory and choose new file and type `.env`.
> Then type the two lines you see above into that new .env file.

9 Rules for All Labs

If you have reached this step, you are done! If all works correctly, you are prepared for the upcoming Bobathon. Please also remember to follow these rules throughout every lab:

> Always replace n with your team number in every prompt — SAMCOn becomes SAMCO1, SAMCO2, etc. Getting this wrong is the most common source of confusion.

> Use IBM i Developer mode for all labs. Use the mode selector in the Bob chat panel before you begin.

> Click Approve when Bob asks before running a command. That is the guardrail working as designed — not an error.

> Keep the workspace open between labs.

> Check your connection if Bob stops mid-task. SSH sessions can time out. Reconnect via the IBM i panel and continue.